Hong Kong

H 978

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A. Background

Prior to the transfer of sovereignty from Great Britain to China in 1997, Hong Kong was treated in subject cataloging practice as an autonomous entity. Since July 1997, Hong Kong is treated as a political division of China. This instruction sheet describes that practice.

B. Recent revisions

2026-08: Updated template. Updated instructions related to Hong Kong qualifiers for buildings, parks, etc. in Section E.

C. Treatment as a political division of China

Treat ***Hong Kong (China)*** as an administrative division of China rather than as a country, assigning as required subdivisions that are appropriate for use under political divisions of countries (see H 1140).

Examples:

```
651 #0 $a Hong Kong (China) $x Officials and employees.
651 #0 $a Hong Kong (China) $x Social conditions.
```

D. Geographic subdivision practice

When using ***Hong Kong*** as a geographic subdivision, divide through China.

Examples:

```
650 #0 $a Agriculture $z China $z Hong Kong.
650 #0 $a Secret societies $z China $z Hong Kong.
```

Also divide through ***China*** for localities within Hong Kong used as geographic subdivisions.

Example:

```
650 #0 $a City planning $z China $z Victoria Harbor.
```

E. Establishing headings for entities in Hong Kong

Use ***(China)*** to qualify geographic features within Hong Kong.

Examples:

```
151 ## $a Mirs Bay (China)
151 ## $a Wang Lang Island (China)
```

Use the qualifier ***(Hong Kong, China)*** only if it is necessary to distinguish between an entity in Hong Kong and another entity with the same name and of the same type located elsewhere in China.

Qualify buildings, parks, archaeological sites, and other entities of the type that may be qualified by names of cities by the qualifier ***(Hong Kong, China)***.

Example:

```
151 ## $a Lizhengwu Site (Hong Kong, China)
```

Note: The previous practice added a qualifier based on the name of the appropriate locality in Hong Kong to buildings, parks, etc. This practice changed in June 2026.

Divide topical headings that are used as broader terms for named entities in Hong Kong by ***China***, not ***Hong Kong***.

Examples:

```
151 ## $a Hong Kong Island (China)
550 ## $w g $a Islands $z China
```

F. Transfer of sovereignty

Assign to works about the 1997 transfer of sovereignty over Hong Kong to China the subject heading ***Hong Kong (China)--History--Transfer of Sovereignty from Great Britain, 1997***.

G. Geographic area code

Assign the code a-cc-hk.

Revision history

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